Sarah Chen

Senior Software Engineer
https://sarahchen.example.com | https://example.com/in/sarahchen | https://example.com/sarahchen
sarah.chen@example.com | +1 (415) 555-0142 | San Francisco, CA

EDUCATION

WESTBROOK STATE UNIVERSITY
B.S. in Computer Science
Sep 2016 - May 2020
Graduated with honors. Capstone: a distributed task scheduler in Go.

LINKS

LinkedIn:// **sarahchen**
GitHub:// **sarahchen**

SKILLS

Technical Skills:
Python • Go • TypeScript • SQL • FastAPI • Node.js • PostgreSQL • pgvector • Redis • AWS • Docker • Kubernetes • Terraform • OpenTelemetry • Azure OpenAI • RAG • LLM evaluation • CI/CD

Languages:
English (native) • Mandarin (conversational)

Certifications:
AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate

SUMMARY

Senior software engineer with 6 years of backend experience in Python and Go, including 3 years shipping LLM features to production. Designs retrieval pipelines and the offline evaluations that gate prompt and model changes.

EXPERIENCE

FERNWAY PAYMENTS | Senior Software Engineer

Jul 2024 - Present | San Francisco, CA

- Shipped a RAG support assistant on Python, FastAPI and pgvector that resolves 38% of merchant tickets without human handoff.
- Built an LLM evaluation suite of 1,200 labeled conversations with LLM-as-judge and exact-match scorers; it runs in CI as a regression gate before any prompt or model change merges.
- Cut LLM spend by 46% through model routing and caching: ticket classification moved to a fine-tuned 8B model and repeat queries are cached in Redis.
- Instrumented every LLM call with OpenTelemetry tracing and per-feature cost dashboards, so the team can see latency, quality and spend by release.
- Led design reviews and mentored 3 engineers on the AI platform team.

KESTREL HEALTH | Software Engineer II

Apr 2022 - Jun 2024 | Seattle, WA

- Built a clinical note summarizer on Azure OpenAI with PHI redaction, used by 1,400 clinicians across 60 clinics.
- Developed the patient scheduling API in TypeScript and Node.js for 1.2M monthly users, and added contract tests that cut production incidents by 40% year over year.
- Implemented HIPAA audit logging and role-based access control across 12 internal services.

LANTERN LOGISTICS | Software Engineer

Jun 2020 - Mar 2022 | Portland, OR

- Built route-optimization services in Go and Python that cut average delivery planning time from 40 to 9 minutes.
- Moved a monolithic order service onto Kubernetes on AWS, cutting deploy time from 45 minutes to 8 and enabling daily releases.
- Wrote the Terraform modules the team used to provision staging and production environments in under an hour.

PROJECTS

PROMPTDIFF | Creator and maintainer

Mar 2024 - Present | example.com/sarahchen/promptdiff

- Open-source CLI that reports per-case regressions between model versions and prompt revisions; 700+ GitHub stars.
- Plugs into CI so a pull request fails when answer quality drops on any labeled case.

PGVECTOR-BENCH | Author

Jun 2023 - Sep 2023 | example.com/sarahchen/pgvector-bench

- Benchmark harness comparing HNSW and IVFFlat index settings on 5M-row embedding tables, with the findings published as a write-up.

AWARDS

2025 Fernway Engineering Excellence Award